GET LUCKY GOLF × BUSINESS PLAN

A golf day in your pocket · August 2026 · Confidential

In one line: the only money-game app with a $100,000 insured jackpot on the slip. The fourball's bet card — skins, nassau, dots, teams — with a live ledger, netted settlement, and a Santam-underwritten prize the whole group buys into. Peer games are free forever; Get Lucky earns from a $10/month subscription and insured jackpot entries — never from the players' bets.

Why the money game

Twelve months and 10,000 paid entries of proof of concept taught us exactly what to build. Golfers engage hardest where someone wins **every hole** — a skins-and-dots round produces 25–54 personal wins a year, the most reinforcing reward schedule in consumer products. Verification is social: the fourball is standing right there, and filming is reserved for the one staged hole with $100,000 on it. And the buying moment is Thursday night in the group chat, where social contagion sells for us. The insured hole-in-one takes its strongest position: the lottery ticket at the till of a shop you were coming to anyway.

The product

The Slip	Built in under a minute: the four, handicaps auto-pulled (every allowance visible and overridable), the game stack, the group jackpot. Sent to the group chat; accepted in one tap with nothing to download; each player's maximum exposure stated before accepting; locks at the first tee.
Formats (v1)	Skins (gross/net, carryovers) · nassau with presses · team better-ball · **dots** (greenies, sandies, the snake — the micro-wins layer) · peer-verified closest-to-the-pin and longest drive
The jackpot	**Group-pooled:** the fourball buys in together — $1 each at $500 up to $100 each at $100,000 — and any ace pays the group. Four filmed swings on one designated hole; verified by Get Lucky; paid by the insurer.
Settlement	Netted to the fewest transfers at the 18th; deep-links to the payment apps the group already uses; a carry-forward ledger for the rest. Get Lucky routes nothing and holds nothing.
Retention	The Season Ledger — lifetime P&L against each named mate — plus one-tap rematch, order of merit, named groups. Nobody deletes the app while they are down to Dave.
Responsible play	Maximum-exposure display, table-stakes caps, self-set loss limits, cooling-off — and **Pride Mode (points only) as the default state**, which is also the compliant mode for restrictive markets.
Launch	**USD-led global, honour mode:** the full experience works everywhere from day one because the app never touches money. Wallets are a later, market-by-market unlock behind geo-flags, only where licensed.

Why no rake — the structural decision

Private bets between players are lawful precisely while **no third party takes a fee or holds the pot** — in South Africa by statute (the informal-bet exemption fails the moment anyone is paid a fee), in the US by precedent (a peer-betting exchange received a cease-and-desist at a 1% commission). Every durable competitor converged on the same structure: Skins App, the category leader, charges $40/year flat and rakes nothing. Get Lucky therefore takes **zero from peer games, permanently** — peer money in play (~$3.7m across 2029) is an engagement KPI, not a revenue line — and monetises the subscription and the insured jackpot instead. This is simultaneously the legal necessity, the proven category structure, and the honest pitch.

Market & competition

Category proof	**18Birdies reports 10m+ golfers** on a free scoring app — and **Ernie Els was its first official investor**. Golfers adopt round-companion apps at tens-of-millions scale.
The money-game niche	Skins App ($40/yr flat, no rake, no custody) leads; Beezer, SettleUp, 18Birdies side games all track-only. Proven demand, shallow monetisation.
What nobody else can do	Put an insured $100,000 on the slip. That takes an underwriter, actuarial credibility, a claims process and verification infrastructure — proven here over 10,000 entries, backed by a JSE-listed insurer and 25 camera-rigged courses.
18Birdies & conflict	Complementary, not competing: it cannot underwrite a jackpot, its side games are points-only, and Ernie sits on both cap tables — making it a natural partner or acquirer.

The model

	2027	2029 — 3-yr plan	2032
Subscribers · actives	3,727 · 10,434	15,085 · 42,237	100,183 · ~280,500
Peer money in play revenue: zero	$0.7m	$3.7m	$23.9m
Subscriptions	R4.6m	R25.2m	R157.9m
Insured jackpot net 66%	R3.0m	R16.3m	R120.4m
Courses · simulators · sponsorship	R6.9m	R21.0m	R50.9m
Total revenue	**R14.5m**	**R61.7m**	**R322.6m**
EBITDA margin	−11.2%	24.2%	38.9%
Milestone flat 3.0×	R53.3m this round	**R185.0m · 3.47×**	**R967.8m · 18.15×**

Assumptions a sceptic can check: churn struck at a hard 5.5%/month, jackpot attach 35% of slips (20% sceptic / 55% bull) at a $10 average ticket, 2.8 actives per subscriber, one money round per active per month. Verification is charged on insured swings only — peer games verify themselves. Peak cumulative drawdown R6.0m against the R8m raise; EBITDA positive from 2028; no further round assumed. Implied IRR ~51% over three years from January 2027 — an unrealised mark, not a realised return.

The decisive number — and the 90-day pilot

The jackpot attach rate on a group slip has never been observed, because nobody has offered this product. So it gets measured before the app is finished: a **90-day manual pilot across the 25 installed courses** — real slips, real jackpots, the existing camera rigs — reading slip creation, jackpot attach and average ticket. Above ~30%, the plan is conservative. Below ~15%, the company course-corrects with the capital intact. Investors are invited to hold the company to this milestone.

Gating milestones before launch

1 · Written counsel opinion on the P2P layer (the existing insured-challenge opinion does not cover it). 2 · **Santam's written sign-off on the peer-game wrapper.** 3 · Ernie Els's counsel sign-off. 4 · Geo-gating feature flags from the first commit. 5 · The pilot, published.

Team & the raise

Johannes le Roux (Founder & MD — built the proof of concept) · founding team of consumer-brand operators · **Ernie Els** (founding partner — 5% non-diluting for name, likeness and network; four majors; has backed golf tech before (first official investor in 18Birdies)) · **Cloud & Things** (technology partner, led by the former CTO of Capitec Bank — owns the app build, verification flow and simulator SDK) · **Santam** (Authorised FSP 3416 — underwriter; R9m contracted sponsor).

R8.0m for 15% — R45.3m pre / R53.3m post. Minimum ticket R1m (1.88%). Use of funds: app build 35% · pilot 10% · simulators 15% · market entry 25% · legal & ops 15%.

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